Linar Abzalov

Data & GIS Specialist

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Summary

Data-focused GIS professional with 4+ years of experience analysing, processing and validating large datasets across infrastructure, environmental and digital mapping projects. Skilled in SQL, Python, Excel and data visualisation, with practical experience integrating multiple data sources, identifying data inconsistencies and producing clear, actionable insights. Strong analytical and problem-solving skills, supported by a BSc in GIS and Cartography and an MSc in Environmental and Industrial Safety. Keen to apply my skills to smart meter data analysis at United Utilities, develop expertise in Azure Databricks and contribute to data-driven solutions that help reduce water consumption.

Core Skillset

GIS & web mapping: ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, spatial joins, digitising, cartography, coordinate reference systems, qgis2web, GitHub Pages, Cloudflare
Data & quality assurance: SQL, SQLite/SpatiaLite, MySQL, Python (Pandas, NumPy), R, spatial validation, data reconciliation, attribution
Infrastructure & land: Utility asset records, field boundary mapping, aerial imagery and raster plan interpretation, technical specifications
Data Analysis & Reporting: Advanced Excel, Power BI, Tableau, data transformation, data validation
Development Tools: Visual Studio Code, GitHub, Jupyter Notebook

Selected GIS Projects

Manchester Building Age Mapping | Interactive map

- Combined OpenStreetMap building footprints (Geofabrik), OS Open UPRN and Energy Performance Certificate (EPC) records into a harmonised building-age dataset using UK source data and documented schemas.
- Used ArcGIS Pro and QGIS to spatially match UPRNs to building polygons, reconcile one-to-many relationships and conflicting construction-age attributes, and check geometry and source coverage.
- Published an interactive web map with qgis2web and GitHub Pages, documenting source attribution and excluding property identifiers from public-facing outputs.

World Exploration Map | Interactive Web GIS

- Developed an interactive web mapping application using MapLibre GL JS, Geoapify APIs and GeoJSON datasets to visualise visited locations and travel routes. Implemented spatial operations using H3, including geometry processing, buffering and deduplication, alongside POI search and route mapping functionality.

Experience

GIS Technician – Yandex | Moscow, Russia | Jul 2021 – Oct 2023

- Investigated discrepancies between source information and mapped road, point-of-interest and boundary features in a high-volume internal web GIS, applying defined mapping specifications.
- Used SQL queries to identify missing attributes, spatial anomalies and records requiring targeted investigation and correction.
- Resolved data-quality issues with cross-functional teams, clarifying source discrepancies and contributing to a 20% reduction in errors.
- Reviewed and corrected 500+ geospatial features daily against production standards while maintaining 90%+ accuracy.

GIS Technician – Data 3 Consulting | Moscow, Russia **|** Oct 2019 – Jun 2020

- Interpreted raster engineering plans and project specifications to capture and attribute gas pipeline, valve and equipment records within a SQLite/SpatiaLite geodatabase.
- Digitised 40+ km of pipeline network per month in ArcGIS, checking asset geometry and attributes against available source documentation.
- Applied Python validation scripts to investigate spatial data inconsistencies, contributing to a 30% reduction in errors.
- Quality-checked updates within a 10M+ record spatial database to support consistent and accurate infrastructure asset records.

GIS Technician – Eurotechnika Tatarstan | Kazan, Russia | Jun 2018 – Jun 2019

- Interpreted aerial imagery to digitise agricultural field boundaries across 100,000+ hectares in ArcGIS, supporting land-use planning and crop monitoring.
- Investigated and validated spatial discrepancies with field teams across three land-use projects, supporting on-time delivery and a 30% efficiency improvement.
- Analysed operational data from 100+ agricultural machines and prepared daily reports for stakeholders.

Additional Professional Experience

AI Trainer & Quality Reviewer — Outlier AI / RWS Group | Remote **|** Feb 2025 – Present

- Evaluated AI-generated text, imagery and video against structured task specifications and quality criteria; documented inconsistencies and evidence-based assessments.
- Created GIS-related evaluation tasks and reviewed model outputs; selected for Outlier's Oracle programme and reviewer responsibilities across multiple projects.

International Relocation & Non-GIS Employment | Oct 2023 – Jan 2025

- Relocated internationally, undertook work outside the GIS sector and settled in the UK.

Education

Master's degree in Environmental and Industrial Safety | Udmurt State University | First-Class Jun 2021

- Main subjects: System analysis | Risk management | Mathematical modelling and forecasting

Bachelor's degree in GIS and Cartography | Kazan Federal University | Upper Second-Class Jun 2019

- Main subjects: GIS | Probability theory and mathematical statistics | Cartography

Certification

Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate (Google, Coursera)

- Developed strong data cleaning, analysis and visualisation skills in programming tools (SQL, R), spreadsheets (Excel, Google Sheets) and BI tools such as Tableau and Power BI.